

See also

Read about lemon sharks (88–89), who also start their lives in the protection of a nursery.



Dolphins leap out of the water to get a better view of their prey.

Females protect the calves in the nursery pod from predators such as sharks.

Nursery pod

Within each pod are small nursery pods, made up of mothers and their calves. Female dolphins even care for the calves of other females. This is called *alloparenting*.

Dolphin calves nurse for up to two years and stay with their mothers for three to six years.

Fully grown

Dolphins use sound to communicate with each other. Each dolphin has its own signature whistle. This allows them to recognize, find, and help each other.

Sperm whale Adult sperm whales dive deep into the ocean to feed. While some mothers go diving, others stay back to protect the calves in the nursery pod.



Horse and foal Just as a dolphin calf can swim as soon as it's born, so a horse's foal can stand and walk shortly after birth. They are both examples of precocious offspring.



Circle of defense Musk oxen protect their young from predators, such as wolves, by forming a circle. They stand with their heads and horns facing outward. The calves hide under their mothers in the center.

